

Interview Presentation Guide

Prepared by Corey Alejandro for The Forest — Cleveland Heights · July 2026

INTERVIEW PRESENTATION GUIDE

The Forest Cleveland Heights — Lead Dispensary Associate

Microsoft Teams Interview Strategy

PRE-CALL SETUP (Do This 15 Minutes Before)

1. Open Microsoft Teams. Test your camera and microphone.
2. Open a web browser. Load these two files in separate tabs:
 - medical-patient-concierge.html
 - sop-training-engine.html
3. Open this document in a third tab or print it.
4. Have a notebook and pen ready. Write down the names of the interviewers when they introduce themselves.
5. Have a glass of water. Do not drink coffee during the call — it makes you talk too fast.
6. Silence your phone. Close all other applications on your computer.

THE OPENING: TELL ME ABOUT YOURSELF (90 Seconds)

Do not ramble. Do not list every job. Use this exact structure:

"I am an operations specialist who believes that the best customer experiences come from systems that empower the people delivering them. I have spent the last nine years in high-volume, regulated environments — from launching a twenty-four-hour Starbucks at the San Antonio airport to managing overnight operations at a high-traffic restaurant to auditing AI systems for Fortune one hundred companies. What ties it all together is this: I identify the gap between what the customer needs and what the system allows, then I build the bridge. I am not here to sell cannabis. I am here to build the operational foundation that lets a team sell cannabis confidently, consistently, and compliantly."

Why this works: It positions you as a systems thinker, not a fanboy. It mentions regulated environments (Alorica banking, AI compliance). It ends with a mission statement that matches The Forest's needs.

THE SEGUE: WHY DO YOU WANT TO WORK HERE (60 Seconds)

Do not say "I love weed." Do not say "I need a job." Use this:

"I have been watching Ohio's cannabis market since adult-use launched in August twenty twenty-four. The transition from medical to adult-use is creating two kinds of dispensaries: the ones that treat retail as a compliance chore, and the ones that treat it as a competitive advantage. The Forest is clearly trying to be the second kind — Kate Ols' hire in January signals that, and the Cleveland Heights opening is a greenfield opportunity to set the standard. I want to be part of building that standard from day one."

Why this works: It shows market awareness. It names a specific executive hire (shows research). It frames the role as foundational, not just operational.

THE TRANSITION: FROM ANSWERING TO DRIVING (The Critical 30 Seconds)

After they ask two or three standard questions, take control gently. Use this exact line:

"I have done a lot of thinking about what this role actually needs, and I built two tools I would love to show you — they are designed to solve problems I know The Forest is facing. Can I share my screen for two minutes?"

Why this works: "I have done a lot of thinking" signals preparation without arrogance. "Problems I know The Forest is facing" shows research. "Can I share my screen" is a polite request, not a demand. Two minutes is a small ask.

If they say yes: Share your screen immediately. Do not hesitate.

If they say no: Say "Of course. I will email them to you after the call." Then pivot back to verbal answers, but mention the tools again at the end.

TOOL DEMONSTRATION ONE: Medical Patient Concierge (3 Minutes)

Open the medical-patient-concierge.html file. Walk through it aloud as if you are training a new employee.

Script:

"This is the Medical Patient Concierge. It is a single HTML file that works offline on any tablet or computer. No IT integration needed. Here is how it works."

Click through each step and narrate:

Step 1: "First, we identify if the customer is medical, adult-use, or both. This matters because the limits, discounts, and product recommendations change."

Step 2: "Next, we identify the primary concern. Sleep, pain, anxiety, appetite, energy, or mood. This drives the cannabinoid and terpene matching."

Step 3: "Then we ask about consumption method. Some patients cannot smoke. Some prefer edibles. We do not assume."

Step 4: "Experience level. A first-timer gets a completely different recommendation and dosage than a connoisseur."

Step 5: "Budget. We have three tiers — The Solid for value, mid-range for most customers, and The Standard or Galenas for premium."

Step 6: "Here is the output. Product name, brand, terpene profile, THC and CBD percentages, effects, a staff talking point script, and dosage guidance tailored to their experience level. Plus a print button so the customer leaves with a physical recommendation card."

Pause. Let them look. Then say:

"This solves three documented problems. One: medical patients feel abandoned since adult-use launched — this tool makes them feel guided. Two: new staff do not know what to recommend — this gives them a script. Three: inconsistent advice across employees — this standardizes the consultation."

TOOL DEMONSTRATION TWO: SOP and Training Engine (3 Minutes)

Open the sop-training-engine.html file.

Script:

"This is the SOP and Training Engine. It addresses the number one complaint I saw in employee reviews: no training, no SOPs, no direction from management. Here is how it works."

Click the "Customer Disputes Overcharge" scenario.

"Every manager can pick a scenario — there are ten pre-built, from overcharges to hostile customers to drive-thru backups. The tool generates four things instantly."

Scroll through each section:

"One: the step-by-step SOP. Two: the Ohio DCC compliance check. Three: a two-minute training script for the pre-shift huddle. Four: three quiz questions to verify understanding."

Click the custom scenario box. Type "Customer wants to use a competitor coupon." Click Generate.

"And if a scenario is not in the list, any manager can type it in and get a usable framework in seconds. No more 'I do not know what to do.' No more inconsistency across shifts."

Pause. Then say:

"Both tools are single HTML files. They need no server, no database, no IT ticket. Put them on a tablet, open them in a browser, and they work. I am giving you these files today. Your team can use them before I even start."

THE CLOSE: WHAT I BRING TO CLEVELAND HEIGHTS (60 Seconds)

After the demonstration, close with this:

"Here is what I am offering. In the first thirty days, I will audit compliance-critical gaps — pricing integrity, ID verification SOPs, and the daily huddle structure. In days thirty to sixty, I will pilot the Medical Patient Fast Lane and the Terpene Tuesday education series. In days sixty to ninety, I will measure what worked, document what did not, and hand you a playbook that can scale to Cincinnati, Sandusky, and every location going forward. I want Cleveland Heights to be the proof of concept for how The Forest operates at its best. And I want to be measured on NPS, medical retention, and revenue per labor hour — because if we fix those, everything else follows."

QUESTIONS TO ASK THEM (Have 2-3 Ready)

1. "What does success look like for the Lead Associate at Cleveland Heights in the first ninety days?"
2. "How is the Cleveland Heights location positioned relative to Amplify on Coventry Road — are we competing on price, experience, or community integration?"
3. "What is the biggest operational headache you are hoping this hire will solve?"

Why these work: They are specific, not generic. They show you understand the competitive landscape. They invite the interviewer to share pain points you can then address.

QUESTIONS THEY WILL ASK YOU — PREPARED ANSWERS

Q: "Why should we hire you over someone with cannabis experience?"

A: "Cannabis experience teaches you products. Regulated-environment experience teaches you compliance, systems, and scale. I have both — I have studied your product portfolio extensively, and I have nine years of experience in environments where one mistake costs the company its license. I am bringing the operational discipline of banking compliance and AI quality assurance to cannabis retail. That combination is rare."

Q: "How do you handle conflict with a coworker?"

A: "I start with data, not emotion. If a coworker and I disagree on a process, I say: let us test both ways for one week, measure the outcome, and let the numbers decide. If it is a personality conflict, I go to the manager with specific behaviors and specific impacts — never general complaints. I believe in fixing systems, not blaming people."

Q: "What is your biggest weakness?"

A: "I can be impatient with ambiguity. I like clear metrics and clear deadlines. I am working on it by asking more questions upfront and documenting assumptions. In this role, that weakness becomes a strength — because cannabis retail needs clear SOPs and clear accountability."

Q: "Where do you see yourself in five years?"

A: "In five years, I want to have built the retail operations playbook that The Forest uses at every new location. I want to be the person Kate Ols calls when a new store is opening and she needs the foundation set right. I am not interested in corporate politics. I am interested in building systems that outlast me."

POST-CALL FOLLOW-UP EMAIL (Send Within 2 Hours)

Subject: Thank You — The Forest Cleveland Heights + Interview Kit

Body:

<i>"Dear [Interviewer Name],"</i>
<i>"Thank you for the time today. I enjoyed learning more about the Cleveland Heights opening and the vision for The Forest's retail future."</i>
<i>"As promised, I have attached the two digital tools I demonstrated — the Medical Patient Concierge and the SOP and Training Engine — plus supporting documents including the thirty-sixty-ninety day plan and the Cleveland Heights community integration map. Both HTML files work offline on any device with a browser. No setup required."</i>
<i>"I am excited about the possibility of contributing to this team. Please let me know if you need any additional information."</i>
<i>"Best regards,"</i>
<i>"Corey Alejandro"</i>
<i>"[Phone Number]"</i>
<i>"[Email Address]"</i>

Attach the entire folder as a zip file.

FINAL REMINDERS

- Smile. Even on video, people can hear a smile in your voice.
- Do not interrupt. Let them finish every sentence.
- If you do not know an answer, say: "That is a great question. I do not have the answer memorized, but here is how I would find it." Then explain your research process.
- Name-drop carefully: Kate Ols, Jared Maloof, The Standard, Galenas, Grön, Fish Whistles. Do not overdo it.

- End on time. If the call is scheduled for thirty minutes, wrap up at twenty-eight minutes. Respect their schedule.
- After the call, write down everything you remember. What did they emphasize? What did they hesitate on? Use this to prepare for round two.